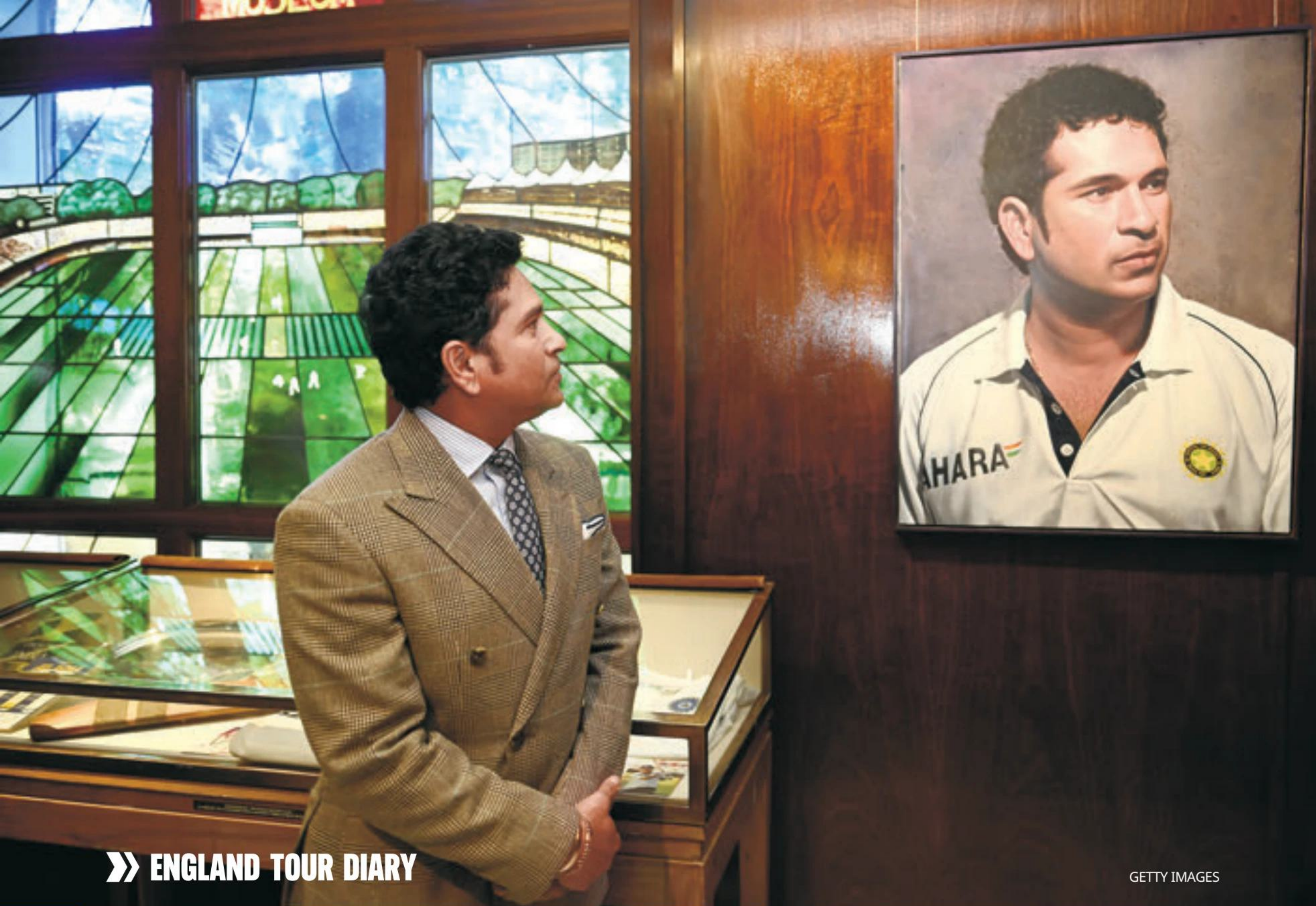




» ENGLAND TOUR DIARY

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CRICKET'S THEATRE OF THE SUBLIME (AND ABSURD)

From Lord's to Leeds, our reporters bring you **on-field drama** and off-field colour — stories of cricket, culture, and characters you won't find on the scorecard.

A Test match at Lord's is like a festival — a melting pot of culture, tradition, and, of course, cuisine. As Sachin Tendulkar says, "Where else would you find cricket legends, rock stars, and deep conversations in one place?"

This time was no different, as the iconic venue welcomed some of the world's leading figures — from across disciplines — who attended the game over five days and soaked up the warm English summer.

While Tendulkar started proceedings by ringing the bell, the Marylebone Cricket Club (MCC) marked the occasion by unveiling a portrait of the former India captain. Painted by Stuart Pearson Wright, miniature versions of the portrait were available at the Lord's merchandise stores and remained one of the best-selling items. "This being the Anderson-Tendulkar Trophy, the MCC launched quite a few souvenirs to honour Tendulkar. While customised sizes of the

painting were available, there were mugs and diaries as well with pictures of Tendulkar. Since a large number of Indian fans attended the game, those items did really well," one of the Lord's store staff told the Diary.

With the temperature soaring and a scorching sun making things uncomfortable for spectators, many preferred watching the game on giant screens placed near the Nursery End, where players trained before and between sessions. While